Topic A: Assignment

Instructions

This assignment asks you to reconstruct and evaluate arguments about whether Pastafarianism qualifies as a religion. Answers to Tasks 1–3 should be submitted as an Argdown file (`.ad`). Task 4 requires a short written commentary (max. 300 words) in PDF or plain text.

Tasks

Task 1: Reconstruct an Argument

Reconstruct the following passage as a premise–conclusion argument in Argdown notation. Identify at least two premises and a conclusion, and give the argument a meaningful name.

> "Courts should not grant religious exemptions to Pastafarians. Pastafarianism was explicitly designed as a parody by its founder. A belief system created as parody cannot be the object of sincere religious belief. And without sincere belief, there is no religion — and without religion, there can be no religious exemption."

Task 2: Formulate an Objection

Which premise of the argument from Task 1 is most vulnerable to objection? Formulate a counter-argument in Argdown notation and connect it to the appropriate premise using an attack relation (`-`).

Task 3: Dialectical Map

Using `argdown-map` notation, produce a dialectical map that includes:

- The argument from Task 1
- Your counter-argument from Task 2
- At least one additional statement node (supporting or being attacked)

Task 4 (optional): Case Study

Locate a real court ruling or administrative decision in which a Pastafarian claimed a religious exemption in any country. Briefly answer:

- What legal right was claimed?
- What did the court/authority decide?
- Which premise of the argument from Task 1 does the court's reasoning most directly support or undermine?

Cite your source using Quarto's citation syntax: `[@key]` for a bibliography entry, or a full reference if the source is not in the course bibliography.

Submission

Submit your Argdown file and the Task 4 commentary (if attempted) via the course platform by **2026-10-20**. File naming: `[matriculation-number]-topic-a.ad` and `[matriculation-number]-topic-a-commentary.pdf`.